Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Thyroid Disease Testing

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCD) as outlined below.

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

1. For individuals with a diagnosis of hyperthyroidism **and** a diagnosis of pregnancy or postpartum, testing for total T4 (CPT code 84436) and antithyroglobulin antibody (TgAb) (CPT code 86800) **ARE REIMBURSABLE**.
2. For individuals with a diagnosis of hypothyroidism or hyperthyroidism, testing for thyroid antibodies (CPT code 83519, CPT code 83520, CPT code 84445, CPT code 86376, CPT code 86800) **IS REIMBURSABLE** once every three years.
3. For individuals with thyroid cancer, testing for serum thyroglobulin (CPT code 84432) and TgAb levels (CPT code 86800) **ARE REIMBURSABLE**.
4. For individuals diagnosed with hyperthyroidism or hypothyroidism, testing for thyroxine-binding globulin (TBG) (CPT code 84442) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**
5. Testing for thyrotropin-releasing hormone (TRH) (CPT code 80438, CPT code 80439), reverse T3 (CPT code 84482), or T3 uptake (CPT code 84479) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**
6. Testing for thyroxine (CPT code 84437) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** for individuals over the age of two.

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure Code	Code Description
80438	Thyrotropin releasing hormone (TRH) stimulation panel; 1 hour. This panel must include the following: Thyroid stimulating hormone (TSH) (84443 x 3)
80439	Thyrotropin releasing hormone (TRH) stimulation panel; 2 hour. This panel must include the following: Thyroid stimulating hormone (TSH) (84443 x 4)
83519	Immunoassay for analyte other than infectious agent antibody or infectious agent antigen; quantitative, by radioimmunoassay (e.g., RIA)
83520	Immunoassay for analyte other than infectious agent antibody or infectious agent antigen; quantitative, not otherwise specified

84432	Thyroglobulin
84436*	Thyroxine; total
84437	Thyroxine; requiring elution (e.g., neonatal)
84442	Thyroxine binding globulin (TBG)
84445	Thyroid stimulating immune globulins (TSI)
84479	Thyroid hormone (T3 or T4) uptake or thyroid hormone binding ratio (THBR)
84482	Triiodothyronine T3; reverse
86376	Microsomal antibodies (e.g., thyroid or liver-kidney), each
86800	Thyroglobulin antibody

** The payment criterion for 84436 applies to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to Novitas Solutions.*

Original Medicare Local Coverage Determination (LCD)

Contractor Name	Policy Title	Policy Number	Procedure Code
Novitas Solutions, Inc	Frequency of Laboratory Tests	L35099	84436

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